

Free fonts

1001freefonts.com, dafont.com and urbanfonts.com are some of the many sites that offer you free fonts

PC becoming slow

If you are experiencing a drop in your PC performance, it could be due to the number of fonts installed

Make your own font (And more!)

Rasagy Sharma

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

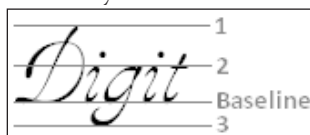
Have you ever wanted to make text appear just like your own handwriting, but never found a font that could do the trick? Is a little personalisation all you need to complete that card you just designed, but all the handwriting fonts seemed too common to use? Here's how to get your own handwriting font using



The template used to create the font

First, head on to the web site (www.fontcapture.com), click on "Create your font now" and download the font template available as a PDF file. Print this sheet and write on it with your handwriting as directed and then scan the sheet (use 200 dpi or higher). Save it as a JPEG or PNG file and upload

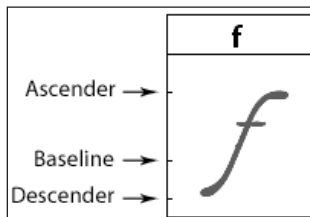
it on the web site. Name the font to identify it. You can then download your own font!



Understanding parts of a font

The quality of the font depends upon how you fill the template sheet, so we should keep a few things in mind. In any piece of text (say "Digit"), the baseline is the imaginary line on which all the letters sit. The uppercase letters fit between baseline and (1) – which gives us the cap height, whereas most of the lowercase letters are between baseline and (2) – which gives us the x-height. A few characters have ascender and / or descender (like 'd' and 'g' respectively), which may cross the x-height.

The template has small guide marks to roughly giving you an idea about how high the ascender can reach, the baseline, and how low the



Using markings in the template

descender can reach. Try and keep the letters inside the top and bottom lines to prevent them from being cut off.



How x-height and baseline affect fonts

What makes a font look different from another is how the x-height and cap height are varied. As evident in the above example, the non-uniform baseline and varied x-height makes the font look more like rough handwriting, whereas uniform baseline and nearly similar ascenders and x-height will give the font a smooth, pleasant feel. Also, for making your font legible, use a black marker / gel pen and avoid using very thin strokes throughout the font, though a few elegant fonts do have varying the stroke thickness.

After a few tries, you'll be able to get a font that nearly looks like something you've written on paper. But that isn't all you do with FontCapture. It can represent alphabets using anything that you fill in the template sheet, which means you can creatively use a few characters that you don't use often to represent some special symbols. In fact, you can use your own symbols to represent



What you can make using Font Capture (Symbols/Emoticons)



What you can't do with FontCapture (Overlapping/running hand/cursive handwriting)

letters and send across coded messages!

One of the main limitations of FontCapture is the lack of space: you can't add fancy frills to a character because the template has a small fixed space for each one of them. Getting a running handwriting font takes a while to master, for which you must start and end the characters at same height. Also, you can't have overlapping characters or even simple cursive characters which might extend into another character's area, which doesn't leave much room for creativity. But you can still come up with many interesting fonts. Possibilities are endless! **d**



Realize your true fitment

Not just Match Making

A problem solving approach towards building high performance teams

At CareerNet, we deliver rewarding career navigation & advice to professionals through an integrated ecosystem of opportunity landscaping, personalized career counseling and smart employment opportunities. We have redefined "discovering right jobs" for high quality professionals across campuses to the board rooms. With our in-depth expertise across various verticals, we have emerged as the "distinctive partner" for leading global firms to assist them in building their dream teams.

Send your latest resume to resume@careernet.co.in

RPO | Executive Search | University Hiring | Bespoke Hiring Solutions | Consulting



Visit us at www.careernet.co.in